

JVD Internal Management System

Design Direction · v1.0 FINAL · 2026-07-04

JVD Design Direction — from the Figma References

Date: 2026-07-04 · Companion to `SYSTEM_AUDIT_AND_REFACTOR_PLAN.md` (Phase 3) Sources reviewed in Figma (view access confirmed):

File	What it is	What we take from it
Micro-Dashboard (5 frames, 1920×962, dark)	Dark project-management dashboard with a smart-animate feature-spotlight sequence	Dark theme, dashboard layout, motion language
Design-2025 (5 frames, 1440×770, light, "linkd")	Applicants management app: home (empty + populated) and a 3-step modal flow	Light theme, list/row patterns, modal wizard, empty states
Dashboard Flaws (8 frames, 1440×792, light)	Notion/Attio-style Employee Management System: data table, incident analytics, activity drawer, share popover, onboarding cards	Data tables, drawers, popovers, onboarding, stats/charts

Together these define one coherent design language — the **Linear/Notion/Attio school**: neutral surfaces, one accent color, pill badges, rounded-16 cards, soft wide shadows, data-dense typed tables, right-side detail drawers, compact centered modals, ⌘K quick actions, and short smart-animate transitions. This document turns that into concrete tokens and components for the JVD frontend.

1. Design Tokens (→ Tailwind v4 @theme in frontend/src/index.css)

1.1 Color — light theme (primary; from Design-2025 + Dashboard Flaws)

Token	Value (approx from Figma)	Use
--color-bg	#FAFAFA	App background
--color-surface	#FFFFFF	Cards, tables, modals
--color-surface-muted	#F5F5F5	Sidebar, table header, input bg
--color-border	#E8E8E8	Hairline borders everywhere (1px, never darker)
--color-text	#171717	Primary text
--color-text-muted	#737373	Secondary text, descriptions, timestamps
--color-primary	#171717 (near-black)	Primary buttons ("Create Listing", "Add", "Send") — black pills, not blue
--color-accent	#1D4ED8 (JVD Blue, deepened)	The ONLY interactive/brand color: links, active nav, focus, selected rows, progress, charts
--color-success	#16A34A on #DCFCE7	"Active", "approved" pills
--color-warning	#D97706 on #FEF3C7 (JVD Yellow → amber)	"pending", expiring — warning states ONLY
--color-danger	#DC2626 on #FEE2E2 (JVD Red)	Destructive, errors, overdue — danger states ONLY

Brand mapping: JVD's trademark red/blue/yellow triad is used *semantically*, never decoratively — blue = interactive, red = danger, yellow = warning; the full triad appears only in the logo, login accent, and report letterheads. Full rationale and uniformity rules: `PRODUCT_IMPROVEMENT_SPEC.md §1`.

1.2 Color — dark theme (from Micro-Dashboard; maps to existing ThemeContext dark mode)

Token	Value	Use
--color-bg	#000000	App background (true black)
--color-surface	#0D0D0D – #141414	Cards with #262626 hairline borders
--color-text	#FAFAFA / muted #8A8A8A	
--color-accent	#3B82F6 (vivid blue)	Timeline bars, active states, send buttons

1.3 Shape, elevation, spacing

- Radius: cards/modals 14–16px, inputs/buttons 10–12px, pills 9999px, table rows 8px. (Measured: Share Popover 14.17px, Onboarding cards 12px.)

- **Shadow (floating elements only — popovers, modals, drawers):** `0 4px 100px rgba(0,0,0,0.15)` — soft, huge blur, near-zero offset. Cards on the canvas get **border, not shadow**.
- **Borders over shadows** for resting elements; elevation is reserved for things that float.
- **Spacing:** 16px base padding (Figma padding blocks read 16/8/16); dense tables 8px vertical; page gutters 24–32px.
- **Buttons:** pill or 10px radius; primary = solid near-black (light) / white-on-dark; secondary = 1px border, transparent fill; heights ~36px.

1.4 Typography

- One grotesque sans throughout (Inter or Geist; the Figma uses an Inter-class face).
- Page title ~22–24px semibold with a one-line muted description under it (see "Employee Management System" / "Incident Tracking" headers).
- Table/body 13–14px; labels/timestamps 12px muted.
- Big stat numbers (dashboard) ~28–32px semibold with a muted unit label ("214 Total").

1.5 Motion (from Micro-Dashboard's prototype settings + Micro-Animations)

Figma interactions read: **Smart animate, ease-in-and-out, 1000ms, staged delays 600–1600ms** for the showcase. For a working app, scale that down:

- **Standard easing:** `cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)` everywhere.
- **Durations:** hover/press 120–150ms · dropdown/popover 180ms · modal/drawer 250–300ms (fade + 8px slide/scale-from-98%) · page content 200ms fade-up with 30–50ms per-item stagger on lists.
- **Skeletons, not spinners:** the Drawer frame shows gray skeleton blocks behind the drawer — use skeleton placeholders shaped like the final content for all loading states.
- Implement with `framer-motion` (already installed): one `<AnimatePresence>` wrapper per Modal/Drawer/Toast, a shared `stagger` variant for lists. No bespoke animation code in pages.

2. Component Library (build in `components/ui/` , one PR each)

Each maps directly to something visible in the Figma files:

#	Component	Spec (from Figma)	Replaces in JVD today
1	AppShell / Sidebar	Fixed left sidebar on muted bg: workspace block (logo + org + chevron), "Quick actions ☰K" row, nav items w/ icon + label + optional "New"/count badge, active item = filled soft-gray rounded row; Help Center pinned bottom	Current layout in <code>components/layout/</code>
2	CommandPalette	☰K opens search-everything dialog (nav, actions, entities)	New — the single biggest "feels professional" win
3	DataTable	Header: breadcrumb, title + muted description, tab bar (entity views + "+"), toolbar right (sort ↑, filter, view, search, customize, black Add pill). Body: checkbox col, typed column headers w/ icons, colored category dots, status pills, inactive rows grayed w/ strikethrough, row hover reveals actions, kebab menu	Every hand-rolled table (Employees, Users, Invoices, TripTickets...)
4	ListRow card	Design-2025 pattern: white rounded row, title + status pill, subtitle w/ icon + date, right-side ghost action buttons (☆ Shortlist / ✉ Outreach analogs) + kebab	HR Applications, task lists, approval queues
5	StatusPill	Colored pill, lowercase label, tinted bg + strong text (green/yellow/red/indigo)	<code>StatusBadge.tsx</code> (restyle)
6	Modal (wizard-capable)	Compact centered card ~360–420px, radius 16, title left, optional search field, content list, footer = ghost secondary left + solid black primary right; supports multi-step (Choose template → Compose → Confirm)	<code>Modal.tsx</code> + <code>sweetalert2</code> usages
7	Drawer	Right-side panel: title + close, info banner (tinted blue, rounded), vertical activity timeline (dot + title + timestamp, nested detail card w/ avatar rows, dataset tags, summary, action link)	<code>EntityPreviewPanel.tsx</code> — extend, don't replace
8	SharePopover	Invite input + role dropdown + Invite btn; "General access" rows w/ icon + title + subtitle; people list w/ per-person role dropdown; footer link + black "Copy Link" btn	Portal-link sharing, document sharing
9	StatCard + Chart	Big number + muted label + "View all >", indigo bar chart (rounded tops, hairline gridlines, muted axis) via existing <code>recharts</code>	Dashboard widgets in <code>pages/dashboards/</code>
10	EmptyState	Centered: bold one-liner ("No applicants yet"), muted explanation, primary black CTA + ghost "Learn more"	Every blank table/list today
11	OnboardingChecklist	Floating card: "Getting started" title + collapse, checklist w/ filled-blue done circles, "Watch tutorial" ghost row, footer "4 of 6 complete" + indigo progress bar	New — user onboarding for each module
12	FeatureCallout / Tooltip card	Small card (≈184×195): illustration, bold title, muted body, "Dismiss" dark button; + "New Feature" changelog card w/ date + NEW badge	Release announcements after refactor phases
13	Toast	Single system (react-hot-toast, restyled to tokens)	Kills the <code>sweetalert2/toast</code> split
14	GanttTimeline (later)	Micro-Dashboard's project overview: phase columns w/ blue range bar + milestone dots w/ date labels	Travel bookings / trip scheduling views

Rules: pages compose these and never hand-roll tables, modals, pills, or empty states again. One icon set (`lucide-react`), delete `react-icons` as pages migrate. Storybook (or a simple `/design` route) renders every component in all states.

2.1 Surface Decision Guide — modal vs drawer vs page vs toast

Current state (measured): 38 pages use the shared `Modal`, 22 pages hand-roll their own `fixed inset-0` overlays (most without `max-height` → the "content won't fit" bug), 10 `swal.fire` calls still exist alongside 291 `toast` calls, and only `EntityPreviewPanel` behaves like a drawer. Everything else pops dead-center regardless of what it is. These rules make the choice mechanical:

Ask one question: what is the user doing?

Surface	Use when	Size/behavior	Never for
Toast	Reporting an outcome; no decision needed ("Invoice saved")	Auto-dismiss ~4s, top-right; only button allowed is Undo	Errors needing action; anything with a form
ConfirmDialog (small centered)	ONE irreversible yes/no ("Delete this supplier?")	≤400px; title + one sentence + Cancel/ghost + action button (red if destructive)	Forms; multi-choice; info dumps
Modal (centered, compact)	Creating or completing one small thing : quick-add record, a wizard step (the Design-2025 flow)	Widths 400/480/560; <code>max-h-[85vh]</code> with sticky header/footer and scrollable body; radius 16px	Anything with tabs, tables, or >~6 fields; editing existing records with context
Drawer (slides from the right)	Viewing/acting on an existing record without leaving the list : entity preview, approval detail + workflow timeline, activity/audit history, filters, notifications panel	400–560px wide, full height, scrollable, list stays visible behind (the Figma "Proposal Activity" pattern)	Creating brand-new complex records; primary navigation
Full page (route)	Anything complex: >6–8 fields, multi-section forms, embedded tables, needs a shareable URL/back button (invoice creation, contract builder, payroll run, checkout)	Normal route with breadcrumb	—

(Note: drawers slide from the right — the left edge belongs to the nav sidebar. The Figma reference drawer is right-side too.)

Escalation rules (these catch 90% of today's misuse): 1. If a modal needs to scroll a lot, grow tabs, or open **another** modal → it should have been a **page** (or the second step of a wizard). Nested modals are banned. 2. If the user needs to see the list/table while working → **drawer**, not modal. 3. If nothing is being asked of the user → **toast**, not a dialog. (This retires all 10 `sweetalert2` success/error popups: outcomes → toast, confirmations → `ConfirmDialog`.) 4. One overlay at a time; a drawer may spawn a `ConfirmDialog`, nothing else. 5. All overlays: `Esc` + overlay-click to close (blocked only mid-destructive-action), focus trap, body scroll lock — provided by the shared components, which is why hand-rolling is banned.

Migration: delete `sweetalert2` (10 call sites → `ConfirmDialog/toast`); convert the 22 hand-rolled overlays to shared `Modal / Drawer` as each page is redesigned; retag current center-modals that are really record-detail views (approvals, previews, document views) as drawers; normalize `Modal` radius from `2.5rem` to 16px per §1.3.

3. Mapping to JVD Screens (Phase 3 order)

1. **Login / 2FA / Set-password** — first impression; centered card on `--color-bg`, black pill CTA, motion on transitions between steps.
 2. **App shell + sidebar + HK** — restyles every page at once; biggest visible jump.
 3. **Dashboards** — `StatCard` + `Chart` + activity feed (Micro-Dashboard layout, light theme by default, dark theme supported).
 4. **HR Employees** — the Dashboard-Flaws Employment Table is literally this screen (departments, active/inactive, payroll tabs). Build `DataTable` here first.
 5. **HR Applications** — Design-2025 is literally this screen (applicants, shortlist/outreach, listing wizard). Use `ListRow` + `Modal` wizard.
 6. **Sales checkout + contracts** — `Modal` wizard + `SharePopover` (portal links) + `Drawer` (contract activity timeline).
 7. **Accounting / Travel / Logistics / the rest** — `DataTable` + `Drawer` + `EmptyState` conversions, module by module.
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4. Practical notes

- The files are **view-only** for our account (`m=dev` Dev Mode inspect requires an editor seat — "Request access" if exact px/hex exports are wanted; the values above were read visually and from the properties panel and are close enough to start).
- The "micro"/"linkd" branding in the references is template branding — swap in JVD identity (logo, brand accent) at the `AppShell` level via tokens, nothing else changes.
- Light theme is the default for the working app (all data-dense references are light); the Micro-Dashboard dark theme becomes the polished dark mode for the existing `ThemeContext` toggle.
- Every component lands with its states (default/hover/active/disabled/loading/empty/error) before any page migrates — that's what makes the app feel designed rather than themed.